DIGITAL LITERACY PROJECT REPORT

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INTRODUCTION

This Digital Literacy project aims to enhance students' understanding of safe, professional, and effective use of digital tools. In today's world, having strong digital skills is not optional — it is essential for academic success, professional growth, and personal safety online. Through a series of practical tasks, the project guides students in creating digital awareness resources, building a professional online presence, practising coding and collaboration tools, drafting professional emails, and learning to prevent cybercrimes. By completing these tasks, students develop both technical skills and critical thinking abilities related to digital literacy. This report summarizes the work completed, insights gained, and key learnings from each module, providing a comprehensive view of the overall project experience.

Task 1 – Digital Literacy Awareness Infographic

For Task 1, I created a one-page infographic to explain the concept of digital literacy and its importance for students. I used Canva as the design tool because it offers a user-friendly interface and many templates suitable for educational visuals. The infographic covered three key topics: what digital literacy is, useful digital tools for students, and safe internet practices. It included clear icons, color-coded sections, and concise points to make the information easily digestible. One interesting aspect of creating the infographic was balancing visuals and text to ensure it remained informative but not cluttered. It helped me realize how design choices, like color contrast and spacing, impact readability. Uploading the infographic to the repository reinforced the importance of proper file organization and naming conventions. Overall, this task strengthened my ability to communicate educational content visually and made me more aware of how critical digital literacy is for students in navigating online resources safely and effectively.

Task 2 – Student Digital Portfolio

In Task 2, I built a foundational digital portfolio to establish a professional online presence. I created accounts on GitHub, LinkedIn, and attempted Kaggle (though it wasn't working at the time). On GitHub, I created a profile README that includes my name, branch, year, and a brief sentence about my learning goals. LinkedIn was updated with my education details and expected graduation year. Screenshots of each profile were added to the repository. The purpose of these platforms is to showcase my skills, maintain a professional identity, and connect with peers, mentors, and potential employers. Over the next four years, I plan to use GitHub to document coding projects and contributions, LinkedIn to network with professionals and explore internship opportunities, and Kaggle (once functional) for participating in machine learning competitions and building a project portfolio. This task emphasized the importance of consistency, professional branding, and the long-term value of maintaining a digital portfolio that accurately reflects my skills and achievements.

Task 3 – Coding & Collaboration Platforms

For Task 3, I explored platforms for coding practice and cloud collaboration. I created a HackerRank account and completed the beginner-level challenge "Solve Me First", which helped me review Python basics and problem-solving logic. I also created a Google Form with five questions as a 'Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz' and linked it to a Google Sheet for responses. Screenshots of the completed challenge, form, and spreadsheet were added to the repository. These tools are essential for both individual learning and collaborative projects. Coding platforms like HackerRank provide structured exercises to improve programming skills and prepare for technical interviews. Google Workspace tools, like Forms and Sheets, support collaborative learning, data collection, and analysis. By practising on these platforms, I developed technical skills and an understanding of how digital tools can be

leveraged for both academic and peer-learning purposes. This task highlighted the importance of hands-on practice and using technology to facilitate communication and knowledge sharing.

Task 4 – Professional Email & Social Media

In Task 4, I drafted two professional emails: one requesting an assignment extension from a professor, and another expressing interest in a summer internship. I also created a social media do's and don'ts checklist. Writing the emails reinforced key concepts of professional communication: clear subject lines, polite greetings, structured bodies, and proper sign-offs. The social media checklist emphasized responsible online behavior, such as using privacy settings, verifying information, and avoiding oversharing. One situation that stood out was imagining a student sending an abrupt, confrontational email, which could easily create misunderstandings. Learning to maintain professionalism online is critical to building trust and credibility. This task taught me that concise, respectful, and well-organized communication can prevent misunderstandings and ensure positive digital interactions, both academically and professionally.

Task 5 – Cybercrime Awareness

For Task 5, I focused on UPI/Online Payment Fraud. I wrote a case study describing how fraudsters trick victims through fake payment requests, phishing messages, or calls, often targeting college students who frequently use digital payments. Consequences include financial loss, compromised personal data, and emotional stress. I also created a prevention checklist with actionable tips such as never sharing UPI PINs, enabling two-factor authentication, verifying payment requests, and reporting incidents to the National Cyber Crime Portal (cybercrime.gov.in) or Helpline 1930. While researching, I was most surprised by how easily social engineering tactics can fool even tech-savvy individuals. As a result, I will personally adopt the habit of double-checking any payment request before approval and never sharing OTPs or PINs. This task emphasized the importance of awareness and vigilance to stay safe online.

Conclusion

Completing the Digital Literacy project has been a valuable learning experience. Across the five modules, I gained practical skills in visual communication, professional online presence, coding practice, collaborative tools, digital communication, and cybercrime prevention. Each task reinforced the importance of safe, responsible, and professional behavior in digital spaces. I have developed habits that improve both my academic performance and online safety, and I now understand how to leverage digital tools effectively. Overall, this project strengthened my digital literacy, preparing me to navigate the online world confidently, responsibly, and professionally throughout my college years and beyond.

References

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Google Workspace (https://workspace.google.com)

National Cyber Crime Portal (https://cybercrime.gov.in)